

The Cop and the Anthem

O. Henry · 1904

First published: New York Sunday World, Dec 1904

TEACHER EDITION · CURRICULUM UNIT

AP edition (standards shown for this framework only)

One 90-minute lesson (the whole story), with an optional take-home essay

Syllabus · 90-minute lesson plans · lecture scripts · vocabulary · quizzes with keys · writing prompts at eleven rigor levels · SAT-style items · whole-book test · essays

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Contents and unit overview

1. Unit overview and the 90-minute lesson
2. Syllabus (weekly pacing)
3. Lesson 1: introduction (author, context, reception, overview)
4. Lesson plans and lecture scripts (chapters 1–1), each with vocabulary, discussion questions, annotation focus, quiz and key, writing prompts and SAT-style items
5. Unit test (eleven rigor versions) with answer keys and scoring guides
6. Final paper
7. Essay assignments at eleven rigor levels

Edition: Reading text: https://en.wikisource.org/wiki/The_Four_Million/The_Cop_and_the_Anthem (revision 14232999), cleaned for Liber et Libri.

Grades: Grades 9–12 (accessible text, well suited to the scaffolded-support track; scales to graduate via rigor levels). Short story: read whole in one 90-minute lesson (assign longer stories as pre-reading). The scaffolded-support track works from the full text with scaffolds. **Weeks:** 1. **Class days:** 2 × 90 minutes (1 chapter lessons plus seminar, test and essay days).

Essential questions

- What does The Cop and the Anthem suggest about homelessness and society?
- What does The Cop and the Anthem suggest about fate and irony?
- What does The Cop and the Anthem suggest about redemption?

Objectives

- Students will cite at least 2 quotations, with locations, to support each written claim about what the text says explicitly and implicitly (scored on the writing-prompt rubric).
- Students will trace one theme across at least 3 sections of the story in the final paper, earning at least 70 of 100 rubric points.
- Students will explain how characters, setting and point of view interact in at least 3 exit tickets, each meeting the claim-evidence-reasoning criteria.
- Students will determine the in-context meaning of taught vocabulary, scoring at least 80% on the vocabulary items of the story quizzes.
- Students will write an argument with a clear claim, reasons and relevant evidence, scoring at least 80% on the unit test's short-answer scoring guides.

Standards: AP

AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.SET, AP-LIT.STR, AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.FIG, AP-LIT.LAN

AP English Literature and Composition big ideas (our summaries; apcentral.collegeboard.org)

Assessments: Daily story quizzes (auto-graded); Weekly writing prompt (rubric); Socratic seminars (scheduled days); Whole-story test (scheduled day); Final essay (scheduled day); College Sophomore and above write one essay of the five
Differentiation: Every prompt and quiz has eleven rigor levels (Scaffolded support through Graduate / PhD); the app applies student override, then class standard, then the automatic level. Each prompt is tagged for Common Core, Indiana 2023, Dual Credit (Indiana College Core), AP and Cambridge where they apply.
Materials: Liber et Libri reader; Annotation journal; Story lecture slides or script

The 90-minute lesson

#	Segment	Mode	Minutes	Clock
1	Bell-ringer	You do	8	0–8
2	Vocabulary with etymology notes	I do	10	8–18
3	Background and context	I do	10	18–28
4	I do: modeled close reading	I do	12	28–40
5	We do: guided annotation	We do	15	40–55
6	You do: independent annotation	You do	15	55–70
7	Discussion	We do	10	70–80
8	Exit ticket / chapter quiz	You do	7	80–87
9	Closure	I do	3	87–90
	Total		**90**	

Syllabus

Week	Chapters	Lessons	Focus and activities	Assessment
1	*Introduction: author, context and reception* The Cop and the Anthem	2 × 90 min (180 min)	*homelessness and society* • Daily 90-minute lesson: bell-ringer, vocabulary and word histories, background, I do / We do / You do, discussion, exit ticket, closure • Story quizzes in the app • Introduction: author, context and reception • Writing prompt at assigned rigor (one graded per week)	Quiz average plus one graded writing prompt

Lesson plans and lecture scripts

Each chapter is one 90-minute class. Scripts are a starting point; adapt them to your students. Teacher summaries contain spoilers.

Lesson 1: Introduction to The Cop and the Anthem

Objective: Students will explain, in a 3-sentence exit ticket, how one fact about O. Henry's life or times connects to homelessness and society in “The Cop and the Anthem”, and will set up a reading journal with a prediction and a question for each of 3 themes (homelessness and society, fate and irony, redemption).

Standards: AP: see the unit standards

Author biography

O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter, born on 11 September 1862 in Greensboro, North Carolina. He trained as a pharmacist, moved to Texas, and worked as a draftsman, bank teller and humorous journalist. Convicted of embezzling from the Austin bank where he had worked (he maintained his innocence), he served about three years in the Ohio Penitentiary (1898–1901), where he began publishing stories as O. Henry. In New York he wrote a story a week for the New York World and produced hundreds of tales of ordinary city people, famous for their warmth, wordplay and twist endings. He died in New York on 5 June 1910.

Historical and cultural context

Around 1900 the homeless men of New York's parks faced brutal winters. "The Island" was Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) in the East River, site of a workhouse and prison where petty offenders served short terms; for some, a winter there meant food and shelter.

Publication and reception, then and now

First published in the New York World in December 1904; collected in The Four Million (1906).

Then: Popular with O. Henry's large newspaper audience.

Now: Taught for its situational irony and its satire of a society in which jail is the only shelter for the poor.

Overview (spoiler-free)

Soapy, a homeless man, decides to get himself arrested so he can spend the winter on the Island. He tries crime after crime.

Main themes

- irony of fate.
- poverty and society.
- redemption.

Why it matters

The story satirizes how society treats the poor and asks whether people get the chance to change.

Spoilers · teacher only

Every attempt fails. Moved by an organ anthem outside a church, he resolves to reform and find work, and at that moment a policeman arrests him for loitering; he gets three months on the Island.

Lesson plan (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Before we open The Cop and the Anthem: Have you ever gotten exactly what you wanted at exactly the wrong moment?
Prompt: Before we open The Cop and the Anthem: Have you ever gotten exactly what you wanted at exactly the wrong moment?

8–18 min · Key terms · I do (10 min)
Key literary terms for the unit.
situational irony; satire; diction; Blackwell's Island.

18–28 min · Mini-lecture: author, context, reception · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture on the author, the historical context and the reception (read or adapt the script).
About the author. O. Henry was the pen name of William Sydney Porter, born on 11 September 1862 in Greensboro, North Carolina. He trained as a pharmacist, moved to Texas, and worked as a draftsman, bank teller and humorous journalist. Convicted of embezzling from the Austin bank where he had worked (he maintained his innocence), he served about three years in the Ohio Penitentiary (1898–1901), where he began publishing stories as O. Henry. In New York he wrote a story a week for the New York World and produced hundreds of tales of ordinary city people, famous for their warmth, wordplay and twist endings. He died in New York on 5 June 1910. The world of the book. Around 1900 the homeless men of New York's parks faced brutal winters. "The Island" was Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) in the East River, site of a workhouse and prison where petty offenders served short terms; for some, a winter there meant food and shelter. Publication and reception. First published in the New York World in December 1904; collected in The Four Million (1906). Then: Popular with O. Henry's large newspaper audience. Now: Taught for its situational irony and its satire of a society in which jail is the only shelter for the poor.

28–40 min · I do: the book in one passage · I do (12 min)
Model a close reading of one passage using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "ON his bench in Madison Square Soapy moved uneasily." slowly and put it in my own words: On his bench in Madison Square, Soapy moves uneasily. Next, craft. I notice the setting is a public park bench, which tells us he has no home. The strongest word is "uneasily": it shows his discomfort and the coming cold. Then, effect. What does this first sentence suggest about Soapy? My answer: Soapy is homeless and restless; the story will follow his attempts to get to jail.

> *ON his bench in Madison Square Soapy moved uneasily. (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 1)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "ON his bench in Madison Square Soapy moved uneasily." slowly and put it in my own words: On his bench in Madison Square, Soapy moves uneasily. Next, craft. I notice the setting is a public park bench, which tells us he has no home. The strongest word is "uneasily": it shows his discomfort and the coming cold. Then, effect. What does this first sentence suggest about Soapy? My answer: Soapy is homeless and restless; the story will follow his attempts to get to jail.

40–55 min · We do: overview and themes · We do (15 min)
Read the spoiler-free overview together and name the themes to track.
What the book is about (no spoilers): Soapy, a homeless man, decides to get himself arrested so he can spend the winter on the Island. He tries crime after crime. Themes to track: irony of fate.: poverty and society.: redemption.:

55–70 min · You do: reading journal · You do (15 min)
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme, with a prediction and a question (example given).
Set up a reading journal: one page per theme with a prediction and a question. Page: fate and irony. Prediction: Soapy, homeless on his bench in Madison Square, will try to get arrested so he can spend the winter in jail. Question: why does the world keep refusing to give him what he wants?
Task: Set up a reading journal for The Cop and the Anthem: one page per theme, each with a prediction and a question.
Exemplar: Page: fate and irony. Prediction: Soapy, homeless on his bench in Madison Square, will try to get arrested so he can spend the winter in jail. Question: why does the world keep refusing to give him what he wants?

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Whole-class discussion: why the book is still taught.
Why does The Cop and the Anthem still matter? The story satirizes how society treats the poor and asks whether people get the chance to change.
Anchor question: Why might The Cop and the Anthem still be taught today?
Facilitation: The story satirizes how society treats the poor and asks whether people get the chance to change.

80–87 min · Exit ticket · You do (7 min)
Exit ticket on the author and context (answer given).
O. Henry lived in New York and wrote a weekly story for the New York World. How might writing weekly about city life shape his stories? Answer: Accept answers such as: he wrote about ordinary New Yorkers; quick plots with twist endings; humor and sympathy for the poor.
Exit ticket: O. Henry lived in New York and wrote a weekly story for the New York World. How might writing weekly about city life shape his stories?
Answer: Accept answers such as: he wrote about ordinary New Yorkers; quick plots with twist endings; humor and sympathy for the poor.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Preview the first reading.
Tomorrow we begin reading: The Cop and the Anthem.

Teacher notes · sources: Britannica, "O. Henry" (https://www.britannica.com/biography/O-Henry); NCpedia, "Porter, William Sydney (O. Henry)" (https://www.ncpedia.org/biography/porter-william-sydney); O. Henry Museum (Austin) (https://www.austintexas.gov/department/o-henry-museum); NYC Parks, Roosevelt Island history (https://www.nycgovparks.org/)

Lesson 2: The Cop and the Anthem

Focus: a reversal that punishes a change of heart

Objective: Students will analyze how irony develops in "The Cop and the Anthem" by writing a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph that cites at least 2 quotations from the section, and will score at least 80% on the section quiz.

Standards: AP: see the unit standards

Content note (homelessness, petty crime, alcohol or drugs (mentioned)): Sensitive content: Homelessness; petty crime. Preview the story, tell students in advance, and allow a pass on reading aloud. Keep discussion on how the writer uses these elements, not on graphic detail. This section mentions drinking or a drug ("…r cakes and an eye like the cherry in a Manhattan cocktail. "Hey, Con!" Neatly upon his left ear o…"). Treat it as period custom or plot detail; name it plainly and don't glamorize it.
Student preview: Heads-up: this story includes homelessness; petty crime.
Suggested language: "Why does the writer include this, and what does it make us notice?"

Teacher only · spoilers

Soapy, a homeless man in Madison Square, wants three warm months in jail on Blackwell's Island for the winter. He tries to get arrested: skipping a restaurant bill, breaking a window, harassing a woman, disturbing the peace, stealing an umbrella. Every attempt fails. Moved by church music, he resolves to reform and find work, and at that moment a policeman arrests him for loitering; he gets three months.

Background: Published in 1904. Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) held New York's workhouse and jail.

Significance: A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing.

Lesson plan and lecture script (90 minutes)

0–8 min · Bell-ringer · You do (8 min)
Students write to the bell-ringer, then pair-share.
Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society? Write for five minutes. Starters: I think... because... / This connects to redemption because.... Content note before we start: Heads-up: this story includes homelessness; petty crime.
Prompt: Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?
Sentence starters: I think… because… · This connects to redemption because…
Strong response: A strong response takes a position and anticipates this: the anthem awakens his conscience.

8–18 min · Vocabulary with etymology notes · I do (10 min)
Five key words in context, with verified word histories.
Today's words: loitered — lingered; hung about; congenial — pleasant and well suited; scorned — look down on with disdain; impudent — marked by casual disrespect; motives — reasons for doing something. "impudent": Origin: Latin impudēns ("shameless").
Words: loitered: lingered; hung about · congenial: pleasant and well suited · scorned: look down on with disdain · impudent: marked by casual disrespect · motives: reasons for doing something

18–28 min · Background and context · I do (10 min)
Mini-lecture (read or adapt the script).
Published in 1904. Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) held New York's workhouse and jail. A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing. Irony: Every crime fails; innocence is punished. Diction / vocabulary: Ornate vocabulary ("hegira," "Arcadia") gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans. Structure: A series of attempts, each foiled, builds to the reversal. Watch for the anthem: memory of his better past and a call to change.

28–40 min · I do: modeled close reading · I do (12 min)
Model the close reading of the anchor quotation using the written think-aloud below.
First, meaning. I read "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" slowly and put it in my own words: Soapy wants three months in the jail on the Island to escape winter. Next, craft. I notice that "craved" usually goes with food or comfort, not jail. The strongest word is "craved": it shows how desperate he is that prison seems like comfort. Then, effect. Why does Soapy want to go to jail? My answer: Soapy wants to go to jail because winter is coming and he is homeless, so a warm cell with food seems a relief; O. Henry uses this irony to show how harsh poverty is.

> *Three months on the Island was what his soul craved (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4)*

Think-aloud: First, meaning. I read "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" slowly and put it in my own words: Soapy wants three months in the jail on the Island to escape winter. Next, craft. I notice that "craved" usually goes with food or comfort, not jail. The strongest word is "craved": it shows how desperate he is that prison seems like comfort. Then, effect. Why does Soapy want to go to jail? My answer: Soapy wants to go to jail because winter is coming and he is homeless, so a warm cell with food seems a relief; O. Henry uses this irony to show how harsh poverty is.

40–55 min · We do: guided annotation · We do (15 min)
Guided analysis of a second quotation; expected answers given.
Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest? Expected: Arcadia is an ideal paradise; calling a prison that shows how desperate Soapy is. Ask: How does this line connect to redemption? Expected: The anthem awakens his conscience. (Ironic grandeur.)

> *In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia* (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30)

Ask: What words in this line stand out, and what do they suggest?
Expected answer: Arcadia is an ideal paradise; calling a prison that shows how desperate Soapy is.
Ask: How does this line connect to redemption?
Expected answer: The anthem awakens his conscience. (Ironic grandeur.)

55–70 min · You do: independent annotation · You do (15 min)
Independent annotation and a claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph (exemplar given).
Annotate the story for irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Cop and the Anthem develops the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.) Exemplar: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. When the text says "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.
Task: Annotate the story for irony, diction / vocabulary (three marks with a margin note each), then write one claim-evidence-reasoning paragraph: what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Then start your writing prompt at your assigned level (HS Sophomore: Analyze how The Cop and the Anthem develops the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.)
Exemplar: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. When the text says "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4), it shows this directly. Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

70–80 min · Discussion · We do (10 min)
Structured discussion from the 30 tiered questions, with facilitation notes.
Anchor question: Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society? Ask: is the ending funny or tragic?
Anchor question: Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?
Facilitation: Ask: is the ending funny or tragic?

80–87 min · Exit ticket / chapter quiz · You do (7 min)
Story quiz in the app and an exit ticket (answer given).
Story quiz in the app, then: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Support it with one short quotation. Model answer: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. ("Three months on the Island was what his soul craved", The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.
Exit ticket: In one sentence, what does this story suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Support it with one short quotation.
Answer: Model answer: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. ("Three months on the Island was what his soul craved", The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4). Accept any defensible claim backed by a quotation from the story; the answer key for the quiz is in the Quiz section.

87–90 min · Closure · I do (3 min)
Summarize the lesson and preview the next reading.
Today we saw how irony shapes a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Key takeaway: the anthem awakens his conscience.

Total: 90 minutes.

Teacher analysis (spoilers)

Literary elements

- **Irony:** Every crime fails; innocence is punished.
- **Diction / vocabulary:** Ornate vocabulary ("hegira," "Arcadia") gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans.
- **Structure:** A series of attempts, each foiled, builds to the reversal.

Themes and how they develop

- **redemption:** the anthem awakens his conscience.

Symbols and motifs

- **the anthem:** memory of his better past and a call to change.

Key quotations (checked against the reading text)

- "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) His goal.
- "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) Ironic grandeur.
- "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48) The ending.

Model claim-evidence-reasoning

Claim: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose.
Evidence: "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4)
Reasoning: Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

Vocabulary with etymology notes

Word	Definition (in this sentence)	In context	Word history
loitered (verb)	lingered; hung about	*Through one violet-stained window a soft light glowed, where, no doubt, the organist loitered over the keys, making sure of his mastery of the coming Sabbath anthem.*	
congenial (adjective)	pleasant and well suited	*Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable.*	
scorned (verb)	look down on with disdain	*He scorned the provisions made in the name of charity for the city's dependents.*	
impudent (adjective)	marked by casual disrespect	*He made eyes at her, was taken with sudden coughs and "hems," smiled, smirked and went brazenly through the impudent and contemptible litany of the "masher."*	"impudent": Origin: Latin impudēns ("shameless"). (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/impudent#Etymology)
motives (noun)	reasons for doing something	*He viewed with swift horror the pit into which he had tumbled, the degraded days, unworthy desires, dead hopes, wrecked faculties and base motives that made up his existence.*	
magistrate (noun)	a local official who judges minor cases	*An accommodating magistrate would do the rest.*	"magistrate": Origin: Latin magistrātus. (Liber et Libri origin note, https://en.wiktionary.org/wiki/magistrate#Etymology)

Discussion questions

1. Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?
2. Where does irony appear in this story, and what effect does it have? Point to one passage.
3. How does this story connect to the book's larger concern with homelessness and society?

Classroom discussion questions (30, tiered)

Wait time after every question (3 s for DOK 1, 5 s for DOK 2, 8 to 10 s for DOK 3 and 4); think-pair-share on DOK 3 and 4; answer each response with a follow-up probe; close with student-generated questions. Focus sets by rigor level: Scaffolded support: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 11, 12, 13, 14, 21, 22; HS Freshman: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 12, 13, 14, 15, 22, 23, 24; HS Sophomore: 1, 2, 3, 4, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 23, 24, 25; HS Junior: 1, 2, 3, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18, 24, 25, 26, 27; HS Senior: 1, 2, 3, 15, 16, 17, 18, 25, 26, 27, 28, 29; AP: 1, 2, 16,

17, 18, 19, 20, 26, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Freshman: 1, 2, 17, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 27, 28, 29, 30; College Sophomore: 1, 2, 11, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 28, 29, 30; College Junior: 1, 11, 12, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 29, 30; College Senior: 1, 11, 12, 13, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 30; Graduate / PhD: 1, 11, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, 28

Literal / recall

1. What does Soapy want for the winter? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Three months in jail on the Island
2. What happens when Soapy breaks a store window? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: The policeman chases another man
3. What makes Soapy decide to change his life? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Church organ music, an anthem
4. What does Soapy resolve to do? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Find work and reform
5. What finally happens? [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: He is arrested and sentenced to three months
6. Retell the three most important events of "The Cop and the Anthem" in order, in one sentence each. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Soapy, a homeless man in Madison Square, wants three warm months in jail on Blackwell's Island for the winter. He tries to get arrested: skipping a restaurant bill, breaking a window, harassing a woman, disturbing the peace, stealing an umbrella. Every attempt fails. Moved by church music, he resolves to reform and find work, and at that moment a policeman arrests him for loitering; he gets three…
7. Which characters appear or are mentioned in "The Cop and the Anthem"? Name two and one thing each says or does. [DOK 1 · coldCallWithSupport · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: Names and actions taken from the story; check against the teacher summary.
8. Where and when does "The Cop and the Anthem" take place? Point to the line that tells you. [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: A place/time detail quoted from the story.
9. Reread: "Through one violet-stained window a soft light glowed, where, no doubt, the organist loitered over the keys, making sure of his mastery of the coming Sabbath anthem." What does "loitered" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: loitered: lingered; hung about.
10. Reread: "Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable." What does "congenial" mean here, and what is literally happening in this line? [DOK 1 · turnAndTalk · wait 3 s · AP: unit standards] Look for: congenial: pleasant and well suited.

Inferential / analytical

1. What does "The Cop and the Anthem" suggest about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? State the inference and the line that supports it. [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing.
2. Find one example of irony in this story. What does it reveal that a plain statement would not? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: Look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true.
3. How does the setting in this story shape what we understand about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.SET] Look for: Look for where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling.

Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

4. In the passage that begins “The hibernatorial ambitions of Soapy were not of the highest.”, why might Henry have chosen these particular words? Pick two and explain their connotations. [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.FIG] Look for: Diction analysis of two words in the anchor passage.
5. What causes the main turn in “The Cop and the Anthem”, and what effect is it likely to have on what follows? [DOK 2 · followUp · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: Soapy, a homeless man in Madison Square, wants three warm months in jail on Blackwell's Island for the winter. He tries to get arrested: skipping a restaurant bill, breaking a window, harassing a woman, disturbing the peace, stealing an umbrella. Every attempt fails. Moved by church music, he…
6. As the opening story, what does “The Cop and the Anthem” set up that the rest of The Cop and the Anthem will need? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.STR] Look for: A causal or structural link between this and the previous story.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. On structure: A series of attempts, each foiled, builds to the reversal. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. What can we infer about a character's motives from what they say and do here, as opposed to what they claim? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.CHR] Look for: An inference about motive supported by a quoted line.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island,” said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. The bell-ringer asked: “Why might someone prefer jail to life on the street? What does that say about the society?” Now that we have read closely, how would you revise your first answer, and which line changed your mind? [DOK 2 · thinkPairShare · wait 5 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A revised answer anchored in the text.
9. Where does diction / vocabulary appear, and how does it connect this story to the larger concern with homelessness and society? [DOK 3 · followUp · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.FIG] Look for: Look for precise or unusual word choices and their connotations.

   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. On diction / vocabulary: Ornate vocabulary ("hegira," "Arcadia") gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. Background: Published in 1904. Blackwell's Island (now Roosevelt Island) held New York's workhouse and jail. How does knowing this change the way you read one moment in the story? [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.SET] Look for: A specific moment reread in light of the context.

    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable

Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Evaluative / synthesis / creative

1. A critic might argue: "A neat cycle of situational irony that also comments on poverty and policing." How far do you agree? Take a stand and defend it with two lines from the story. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A defended position with evidence and one counterpoint.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
2. Which character in this story acts most wisely, and which least? Judge them by a standard you name. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.CHR, AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: An evaluation using an explicit criterion and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
3. Rewrite one moment of "The Cop and the Anthem" from the point of view of a different character. What does the new angle reveal or hide about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: A creative product with a rationale tied to the text.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
4. Write three questions of your own about "The Cop and the Anthem": one recall, one "why/how", and one "should/what if". Trade with a partner and answer theirs. [DOK 3 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: Student-generated questions at three levels.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
5. Connect this story to fate and irony: is the link strong or weak so far? What would Henry need to show next to strengthen it? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A judgment of thematic development across the work.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his

conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

6. Is the irony in this story effective, or does it feel heavy-handed? Evaluate it as a reader would in a review. [DOK 3 · fourCorners · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.NAR] Look for: An evaluative judgment with criteria and evidence.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. On irony: Every crime fails; innocence is punished. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
7. Compare how "The Cop and the Anthem" treats a reversal that punishes a change of heart with how another text, film or event you know treats a similar idea. What does The Cop and the Anthem see that the other misses? [DOK 4 · socraticCircle · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A cross-text synthesis.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
8. As the final story, does this ending resolve homelessness and society? Argue whether the ending is earned. [DOK 3 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN, AP-LIT.STR] Look for: A prediction or judgment justified with textual clues.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island was what his soul craved" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4): His goal. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
9. Design a one-paragraph modern adaptation of this story (setting, characters, conflict). What must stay the same for it to still be about a reversal that punishes a change of heart? [DOK 4 · thinkPairShare · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A creative transfer that keeps the core idea.
   Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30): Ironic grandeur. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.
10. What question would you most like to ask O. Henry about this story, and what answer do you think the text itself gives? [DOK 4 · studentGenerated · wait 8 s · AP-LIT.LAN] Look for: A student-generated question answered from evidence.
    Answer guidance: A defensible line of argument: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Useful evidence: "Three months on the Island," said the Magistrate" (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48): The ending. Theme link: the anthem awakens his conscience. Credit any position that is supported by quotation and reasoning; push one-sided answers to address the strongest counterpoint.

Annotation focus

- **Irony:** look for gaps between what characters expect or say and what is true (anchor passage in the We do segment)
- Also notice **Setting**: where and when events happen and how place shapes action or feeling
- Also notice **Diction / vocabulary**: precise or unusual word choices and their connotations

Chapter quiz: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What happens when Soapy breaks a store window?

   A. The policeman chases another man

   B. He is arrested

   C. He runs away

   D. The owner thanks him

   Key: A (The policeman chases another man)

2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 8? "Soapy had _____ in himself from the lowest button of his vest upward."

   A. carpenter

   B. confidence

   C. strangers

   D. restaurant

   Key: B (confidence)

3. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 1: "When wild geese honk high of nights, and when women without _____ coats grow kind to their husbands, and when Soapy moves uneasily on his bench in the park, you may know that winter is near at hand." Word bank: sealskin, restaurant, joyfully, roasted

   Key: sealskin

4. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 24? "Sure, Mike,' she said _____, 'if you'll blow me to a pail of suds."

   A. joyfully

   B. carpenter

   C. restaurant

   D. epicurean

   Key: A (joyfully)

5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4: "Three _____ on the Island was what his soul craved"

   Key: months

6. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Soapy resolve to do?

   A. Leave New York

   B. Steal a coat

   C. Find work and reform

   D. Return home

Key: C (Find work and reform)

7. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 9: “But as Soapy set foot inside the _____ door the head waiter’s eye fell upon his frayed trousers and decadent shoes.” Word bank: strolled, confidence, restaurant, policeman

   Key: restaurant

8. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 14? “The _____ saw a man half way down the block running to catch a car.”

   A. pockets

   B. policeman

   C. inhabitants

   D. travelled

   Key: B (policeman)

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What makes Soapy decide to change his life?

   A. A friend's advice

   B. A letter

   C. Church organ music, an anthem

   D. A sermon

   Key: C (Church organ music, an anthem)

10. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “He viewed with swift horror the pit into which he had tumbled, the degraded days, unworthy desires, dead hopes, wrecked faculties and base _____ that made up his existence.” Word bank: scorned, motives, congenial, loitered

    Key: motives

11. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 18: “He arose, joint by joint, as a _____’s rule opens, and beat the dust from his clothes.” Word bank: carpenter, pockets, strangers, travelled

    Key: carpenter

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 23 reveal about the character or situation? “The persecuted young woman had but to beckon a finger and Soapy would be practically en route for his insular haven.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 23) shows the situation turning on homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “practically” and “persecuted” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 2 reveal about the character or situation? “Jack is kind to the regular denizens of Madison Square, and gives fair warning of his annual call.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 2) shows the situation turning on homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “denizens” and “warning” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 9 shapes its tone: “Strong and ready hands turned him about and conveyed him in silence and haste to the sidewalk and averted the ignoble fate of the menaced mallard.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “conveyed” and “sidewalk” (paragraph 9) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral.

That weight points the reader to homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

15. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Claim: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. Explain how this evidence supports the claim: “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4).
    Sample answer: Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that. The evidence is “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) — His goal. This develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience.
16. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 41 to the story's treatment of homelessness and society: “The moon was above, lustrous and serene; vehicles and pedestrians were few; sparrows twittered sleepily in the eaves—for a little while the scene might have been a country churchyard.” Use one other moment from the story as well.
    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 41) develops homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “pedestrians” and “churchyard” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “And also in a moment his heart responded thrillingly to this novel mood.” (paragraph 43), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating homelessness and society as central.
17. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48: “Three _____ on the Island,’ said the Magistrate”
    Key: months
18. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What finally happens?
    A. He gets a job
    B. He is given a coat
    C. He is arrested and sentenced to three months
    D. He goes south

    Key: C (He is arrested and sentenced to three months)
19. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30: “In his fancy the Island seemed an _____ Arcadia”
    Key: unattainable
20. [mc · recall · DOK 1] What does Soapy want for the winter?
    A. A room at a hotel
    B. A train ticket south
    C. A job
    D. Three months in jail on the Island

    Key: D (Three months in jail on the Island)
21. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze the word choice in “Three months on the Island,’ said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48). Pick two words and explain what they suggest.
    Sample answer: The ending. The evidence is “Three months on the Island,’ said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48). This develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “months” and “said” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect.
22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 31 shapes its tone: “Soapy stepped inside, secured the umbrella and sauntered off with it slowly.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “sauntered” and “umbrella” (paragraph 31) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 26 shapes its tone: “The thought brought a little of panic upon it, and when he came upon another policeman lounging grandly in front of a transplendent theatre he caught at the immediate straw of ‘disorderly conduct.’” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “transplendent” and “disorderly” (paragraph 26) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 18 to the story's treatment of homelessness and society: “Neatly upon his left ear on the callous pavement two waiters pitched Soapy.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 18) develops homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “pavement” and “waiters” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “This time the opportunity presented what he fatuously termed to himself a ‘cinch.’ A young woman of a modest and…” (paragraph 19), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating homelessness and society as central.

25. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 8 shapes its tone: “He was shaven, and his coat was decent and his neat black, ready-tied four-in-hand had been presented to him by a lady missionary on Thanksgiving Day.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “missionary” and “presented” (paragraph 8) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Synthesis: trace how redemption develops from the opening of “The Cop and the Anthem” to its ending. Use one quotation from each part.

    Sample answer: Near the start, “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) — His goal. Later, “Three months on the Island,’ said the Magistrate” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 48) — The ending. The anthem awakens his conscience.

27. [fill · recall · DOK 1 · AP: AP-LIT.FIG] Fill in the blank with the vocabulary word that fits: “An accommodating _____ would do the rest.” Word bank: scorned, magistrate, loitered, congenial

    Key: magistrate

28. [short · inference · DOK 2 · AP: AP-LIT.CHR] What can you infer from this line? “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: Ironic grandeur. The evidence is “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30). This develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · AP: AP-LIT.FIG] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

    Sample answer: His goal. The evidence is “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4). This develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “craved” and “months” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · AP: AP-LIT.FIG] In the line “Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable.”, what does “congenial” most nearly mean?

    A. look down on with disdain

    B. pleasant and well suited

    C. lingered; hung about

    D. marked by casual disrespect

    Key: B (pleasant and well suited)

31. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · AP: AP-LIT.NAR] Which literary element does this describe in “The Cop and the Anthem”? Every crime fails; innocence is punished.

    A. Characterization

    B. Allusion

    C. Irony

    D. Tone / mood

    Key: C (Irony)

32. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · AP: AP-LIT.LAN] Connect this passage from paragraph 15 to the story's treatment of homelessness and society: “At a table he sat and consumed beefsteak, flapjacks, doughnuts and pie.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 15) develops homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “beefsteak” and “doughnuts” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “On the opposite side of the street was a restaurant of no great pretensions.” (paragraph 15), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating homelessness and society as central.

33. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · AP: AP-LIT.LAN] Connect this passage from paragraph 43 to the story's treatment of homelessness and society: “Those solemn but sweet organ notes had set up a revolution in him.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 43) develops homelessness and society: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “revolution” and “solemn” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Jack is kind to the regular denizens of Madison Square, and gives fair warning of his annual call.” (paragraph 2), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating homelessness and society as central.

34. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Dual Credit (Indiana College Core): ICC-WC-1.5] In the line “He made eyes at her, was taken with sudden coughs and ‘hems,’ smiled, smirked and went brazenly through the impudent and contemptible litany of the ‘masher.’”, what does “impudent” most nearly mean?

    A. lingered; hung about

    B. marked by casual disrespect

    C. look down on with disdain

    D. pleasant and well suited

    Key: B (marked by casual disrespect)

35. [mc · analysis · DOK 3 · Program outcome: LeL-C2-LIT-1] Which literary element does this describe in “The Cop and the Anthem”? Ornate vocabulary (‘hegira,’ ‘Arcadia’) gives a comic grandeur to Soapy's plans.

    A. Diction / vocabulary

    B. Allusion

C. Setting

D. Conflict

Key: A (Diction / vocabulary)

36. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] In the line “He scorned the provisions made in the name of charity for the city’s dependents.”, what does “scorned” most nearly mean?

A. marked by casual disrespect

B. pleasant and well suited

C. look down on with disdain

D. lingered; hung about

Key: C (look down on with disdain)

37. [mc · inference · DOK 2 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Which choice best states a central concern of “The Cop and the Anthem”?

A. Revenge carried out with perfect control

B. The arrogance and loneliness of seeing differently

C. A symbol of hidden sin that isolates its wearer

D. A reversal that punishes a change of heart

Key: D (A reversal that punishes a change of heart)

38. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · Program outcome: LeL-C3-LIT-1] Close reading: how do the diction and syntax of “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30) shape its meaning? Consider a second, competing reading.

Sample answer: Ironic grandeur. The evidence is “In his fancy the Island seemed an unattainable Arcadia” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 30). This develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “unattainable” and “seemed” carry that meaning: they are the charged choices in the line, and changing either would soften the effect. Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that.

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16	recall 11, inference 2, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	17, 6, 9, 18, 19, 4, 20, 11, 1, 5, 12, 13, 21, 22, 23, 24	recall 10, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	6, 20, 11, 1, 2, 8, 18, 10, 3, 12, 13, 25, 23, 22, 26, 24	recall 9, inference 2, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	27, 6, 4, 7, 5, 8, 2, 3, 12, 13, 23, 25, 22, 15, 26, 16	recall 8, inference 2, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	8, 2, 1, 7, 20, 17, 28, 12, 13, 22, 23, 14, 25, 29, 26, 16	recall 6, inference 3, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	19, 30, 4, 10, 6, 13, 15, 22, 14, 23, 31, 25, 24, 32, 16, 33	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 4
College Freshman	4, 7, 34, 10, 20, 1, 25, 22, 23, 14, 33, 29, 32, 24, 16, 26	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 4, synthesis 6
College Sophomore	10, 30, 20, 7, 2, 13, 25, 14, 23, 22, 35, 15, 33, 32, 24, 16	recall 5, inference 1, analysis 6, synthesis 4
College Junior		recall 5, inference 1, analysis 5, synthesis 5

	27, 1, 10, 20, 36, 37, 23, 21, 25, 14, 22, 32, 16, 33, 38, 24	
College Senior	5, 10, 1, 9, 34, 20, 14, 22, 25, 23, 21, 24, 16, 32, 26, 33	recall 6, inference 0, analysis 5, synthesis 5
Graduate / PhD	11, 10, 1, 20, 36, 22, 31, 23, 14, 15, 25, 33, 32, 24, 16, 38	recall 5, inference 0, analysis 6, synthesis 5

Writing prompts (eleven rigor levels)

Scaffolded support (250 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track (work from the passage your teacher selects). In “The Cop and the Anthem,” how does Henry show a reversal that punishes a change of heart? Write a paragraph that states your claim, quotes two details from the passage, and explains how each detail supports your idea. Use the irony you noticed as one piece of evidence.

HS Freshman (350 words; AP: see unit standards): In The Cop and the Anthem, how does Henry develop the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart? State a clear claim, support it with two or three quotations, and explain how the irony in the story helps build that idea.

HS Sophomore (450 words; AP: see unit standards): Analyze how The Cop and the Anthem develops the idea of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Make a precise claim, support it with at least three pieces of textual evidence, and explain how the author's use of irony and setting shapes that idea. Address one possible counterclaim.

HS Junior (550 words; AP: see unit standards): Analyze how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (where it begins, turns and ends) and its irony shape the reader's understanding of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Identify one place where the text leaves matters uncertain and explain how that uncertainty adds to its meaning. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

HS Senior (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Two readers disagree about what The Cop and the Anthem suggests about a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Lay out two plausible interpretations, weigh the evidence for each (including the story's irony and setting), and argue for the stronger one in a sustained, well-organized essay. Distinguish what is directly stated from what is really meant.

AP (650 words; AP: AP-LIT.NAR, AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument in which you analyze how O. Henry uses irony in The Cop and the Anthem to complicate the reader's understanding of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Develop a defensible thesis, select evidence purposefully, and explain how specific choices of diction and syntax create meaning.

College Freshman (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Situate The Cop and the Anthem within its historical and literary context and argue how the story's treatment of a reversal that punishes a change of heart responds to that context. Engage with at least one secondary perspective (a critic, historian or the author's own statements), integrate quotations smoothly, and cite in MLA style.

College Sophomore (1250 words; AP: see unit standards): Read The Cop and the Anthem alongside the conventions of its genre and period. Argue how the story's handling of a reversal that punishes a change of heart follows or bends those conventions, using the irony as evidence, and test your reading against one published critic. Document two secondary sources in MLA.

College Junior (1500 words; AP: see unit standards): Apply a named critical approach (for example formalist, historicist, feminist, psychoanalytic or ecocritical) to The Cop and the Anthem and its treatment of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. State your method, show what it reveals in the story's irony and setting, and identify where the text resists it.

College Senior (2000 words; AP: see unit standards): Develop a research argument that reads The Cop and the Anthem as evidence for a larger claim about a reversal that punishes a change of heart in The Cop and the Anthem. Connect close reading of the story to the whole story, engage at least four scholarly sources, and state precisely where your reading departs from theirs (Chicago style).

Graduate / PhD (2500 words; AP: see unit standards): Develop an original argument that reads The Cop and the Anthem as a hinge in the story's larger treatment of a reversal that punishes a change of heart. Position your reading within a named critical conversation (for example formalist, historicist, psychoanalytic, feminist or postcolonial approaches), account for the textual history where relevant, and articulate the stakes of your intervention for scholarship on The Cop and the Anthem.

SAT-style questions

1. *He scorned the provisions made in the name of charity for the city's dependents.*

   As used in the text, what does the word "scorned" most nearly mean?

   A. marked by casual disrespect

   B. look down on with disdain

   C. reasons for doing something

   D. a local official who judges minor cases

2. *The hibernatorial ambitions of Soapy were not of the highest. In them there were no considerations of Mediterranean cruises, of soporific Southern skies or drifting in the Vesuvian Bay. Three months on the Island was what his soul craved. Three months of assured board and bed and congenial company, safe from Boreas and bluecoats, seemed to Soapy the essence of things desirable.*

   Which choice best states a central concern of "The Cop and the Anthem"?

   A. A story so convincing it becomes real

   B. Self-destruction and the urge to do wrong

   C. A reversal that punishes a change of heart

   D. Love and rivalry destroyed by racial violence

SAT key: 1. B (look down on with disdain); 2. C (A reversal that punishes a change of heart)

Unit test

The Cop and the Anthem: end test · 90 minutes · 18 questions per rigor version (multiple choice, fill in the blank, short answer). The class rigor level picks the version; student auto-adjust applies.

Short-answer scoring guides

Scaffolded support and HS Freshman (2 points): correct answer in a complete sentence with a detail from the text. HS Sophomore to HS Senior (3 points): claim, one accurate quotation, one sentence of explanation. AP to College Sophomore (4 points): precise claim, two embedded quotations, commentary on word choice or structure, link to theme. College Junior to Graduate (5 points): nuanced thesis, close reading of two passages, synthesis across sections, a competing reading answered. Each item lists a sample answer; partial credit is described in the app.

Unit test: item bank (all eleven rigor versions)

1. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 15: “Into this place Soapy took his accusive shoes and telltale trousers without _____.” Word bank: challenge, inhabitants, strolled, pockets
   Key: challenge
2. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 10? “It seemed that his route to the coveted island was not to be an _____ one.”
   A. epicurean
   B. joyfully
   C. policeman
   D. challenge
   Key: A (epicurean)
3. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 8? “A _____ mallard duck, thought Soapy, would be about the thing—with a bottle of Chablis, and then Camembert, a demi-tasse and a cigar.”
   A. carpenter
   B. sealskin
   C. travelled
   D. roasted
   Key: D (roasted)
4. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 23: “Already he _____ he could feel the cozy warmth of the station-house.” Word bank: strangers, imagined, epicurean, strolled
   Key: imagined
5. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 7: “Soapy left his bench and _____ out of the square and across the level sea of asphalt, where Broadway and Fifth Avenue flow together.” Word bank: confidence, carpenter, strolled, unsuspected
   Key: strolled
6. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 11: “Soapy stood still, with his hands in his _____, and smiled at the sight of brass buttons.” Word bank: confidence, pockets, joyfully, imagined
   Key: pockets

7. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 2? “At the corners of four streets he hands his pasteboard to the North Wind, footman of the mansion of All Outdoors, so that the _____ thereof may make ready.”

   A. inhabitants

   B. strangers

   C. sealskin

   D. carpenter

   Key: A (inhabitants)

8. [fill · recall · DOK 1] Complete the quotation from paragraph 8: “If he could reach a table in the restaurant _____ success would be his.” Word bank: strolled, policeman, sealskin, unsuspected

   Key: unsuspected

9. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 19? “Five blocks Soapy _____ before his courage permitted him to woo capture again.”

   A. joyfully

   B. epicurean

   C. travelled

   D. roasted

   Key: C (travelled)

10. [mc · recall · DOK 1] Which word completes this sentence from paragraph 15? “And then to the waiter he betrayed the fact that the minutest coin and himself were _____.”

    A. challenge

    B. unsuspected

    C. joyfully

    D. strangers

    Key: D (strangers)

11. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 15 reveal about the character or situation? “On the opposite side of the street was a restaurant of no great pretensions.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 15) shows the situation turning on fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “pretensions” and “restaurant” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

12. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 8 reveal about the character or situation? “The total would not be so high as to call forth any supreme manifestation of revenge from the café management; and yet the meat would leave him filled and happy for the journey to his winter refuge.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 8) shows the situation turning on redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “manifestation” and “management” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

13. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 28 reveal about the character or situation? “The policeman twirled his club, turned his back to Soapy and remarked to a citizen.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 28) shows the situation turning on redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “policeman” and “remarked” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

14. [short · inference · DOK 2] What does this passage from paragraph 43 reveal about the character or situation? “And also in a moment his heart responded thrillingly to this novel mood.” Answer in two or three sentences with one detail.

    Sample answer: The passage (paragraph 43) shows the situation turning on fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. The words “thrillingly” and “responded” are the proof, because they show how the moment looks to the people in it. They suggest more than the narrator states outright.

15. [mc · inference · DOK 2] Which of these passages comes earliest in the story?

    A. “Soapy’s mind became cognisant of the fact that the time had come for him to resolve himself into a singular Committee of Ways and Means to…”

    B. “When wild geese honk high of nights, and when women without sealskin coats grow kind to their husbands, and when Soapy moves uneasily on…”

    C. “At the corners of four streets he hands his pasteboard to the North Wind, footman of the mansion of All Outdoors, so that the inhabitants…”

    D. “Jack is kind to the regular denizens of Madison Square, and gives fair warning of his annual call.”

    Key: B (“When wild geese honk high of nights, and when women without sealskin coats grow kind to their husbands, and when Soapy moves uneasily on…”)

16. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 23 shapes its tone: “The young woman faced him and, stretching out a hand, caught Soapy’s coat sleeve.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “stretching” and “sleeve” (paragraph 23) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

17. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 14 shapes its tone: “Men who smash windows do not remain to parley with the law’s minions.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “windows” and “minions” (paragraph 14) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

18. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 20 to the story's treatment of redemption: “It was Soapy’s design to assume the rôle of the despicable and execrated ‘masher.’ The refined and elegant appearance of his victim and the contiguity of the conscientious cop encouraged him to believe that he would soon feel the pleasant…” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 20) develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “conscientious” and “contiguity” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The persecuted young woman had but to beckon a finger and Soapy would be practically en route for his insular haven.” (paragraph 23), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating redemption as central.

19. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 3 shapes its tone: “Soapy’s mind became cognisant of the fact that the time had come for him to resolve himself into a singular Committee of Ways and Means to provide against the coming rigour.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

Sample answer: The words “cognisant” and “singular” (paragraph 3) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

20. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 39 shapes its tone: “At length Soapy reached one of the avenues to the east where the glitter and turmoil was but faint.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “turmoil” and “avenues” (paragraph 39) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

21. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 7 to the story's treatment of redemption: “Up Broadway he turned, and halted at a glittering café, where are gathered together nightly the choicest products of the grape, the silkworm and the protoplasm.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 7) develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “protoplasm” and “glittering” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “He was shaven, and his coat was decent and his neat black, ready-tied four-in-hand had been presented to him by a lady…” (paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating redemption as central.

22. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 43 shapes its tone: “He would pull himself out of the mire; he would make a man of himself again; he would conquer the evil that had taken possession of him.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “possession” and “himself” (paragraph 43) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

23. [short · analysis · DOK 3] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 19 shapes its tone: “This time the opportunity presented what he fatuously termed to himself a ‘cinch.’ A young woman of a modest and pleasing guise was standing before a show window gazing with sprightly interest at its display of shaving mugs and inkstands,…” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “opportunity” and “inkstands” (paragraph 19) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

24. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 25 to the story's treatment of redemption: “With the young woman playing the clinging ivy to his oak Soapy walked past the policeman overcome with gloom.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 25) develops redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “policeman” and “clinging” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The thought brought a little of panic upon it, and when he came upon another policeman lounging grandly in front of a…” (paragraph 26), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating redemption as central.

25. [short · synthesis · DOK 4] Connect this passage from paragraph 37 to the story's treatment of fate and irony: “The policeman hurried to assist a tall blonde in an opera cloak across the street in front of a street car that was approaching two blocks away.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 37) develops fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “approaching” and “policeman” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “At length Soapy reached one of the avenues to the east where the glitter and turmoil was but faint.” (paragraph 39), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating fate and irony as central.

26. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · AP: AP-LIT.LAN] Connect this passage from paragraph 26 to the story's treatment of fate and irony: “Women in furs and men in greatcoats moved gaily in the wintry air.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 26) develops fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “greatcoats” and “wintry” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The policeman twirled his club, turned his back to Soapy and remarked to a citizen.” (paragraph 28), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating fate and irony as central.

27. [short · analysis · DOK 3 · AP: AP-LIT.FIG] Analyze how the word choice in this passage from paragraph 18 shapes its tone: “A policeman who stood before a drug store two doors away laughed and walked down the street.” Pick two words and explain their effect.

    Sample answer: The words “policeman” and “laughed” (paragraph 18) make the tone heavy and deliberate rather than neutral. That weight points the reader to redemption: the anthem awakens his conscience. The author chooses them so the moment feels significant instead of passing.

28. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · AP: AP-LIT.LAN] Connect this passage from paragraph 8 to the story's treatment of fate and irony: “The portion of him that would show above the table would raise no doubt in the waiter’s mind.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 8) develops fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “portion” and “waiter” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “The total would not be so high as to call forth any supreme manifestation of revenge from the café management; and yet…” (paragraph 8), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating fate and irony as central.

29. [short · synthesis · DOK 4 · AP: AP-LIT.LAN] Connect this passage from paragraph 11 to the story's treatment of fate and irony: “At a corner of Sixth Avenue electric lights and cunningly displayed wares behind plate-glass made a shop window conspicuous.” Use one other moment from the story as well.

    Sample answer: This passage (paragraph 11) develops fate and irony: the anthem awakens his conscience. Its words “conspicuous” and “cunningly” carry that idea into this moment. The same concern returns in “Men who smash windows do not remain to parley with the law’s minions.” (paragraph 14), so the two passages read as a pattern, not a single moment. Together they show the story treating fate and irony as central.

30. [mc · recall · DOK 1 · AP: AP-LIT.FIG] In the line “Through one violet-stained window a soft light glowed, where, no doubt, the organist loitered over the keys, making sure of his mastery of the coming Sabbath anthem.”, what does “loitered” most nearly mean?

    A. look down on with disdain

    B. pleasant and well suited

    C. marked by casual disrespect

    D. lingered; hung about

    Key: D (lingered; hung about)

Rigor version	Items (in order)	Mix
Scaffolded support	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16, 17, 18	recall 10, inference 5, analysis 2, synthesis 1
HS Freshman	1, 2, 10, 6, 3, 4, 8, 7, 5, 9, 15, 13, 12, 15, 17, 19, 20, 21	recall 10, inference 4, analysis 3, synthesis 1
HS Sophomore	10, 9, 5, 3, 8, 7, 1, 15, 14, 12, 13, 15, 11, 22, 23, 16, 24, 25	

		recall 7, inference 6, analysis 3, synthesis 2
HS Junior	4, 8, 3, 5, 7, 10, 15, 15, 13, 11, 14, 12, 22, 16, 23, 17, 26, 24	recall 6, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 2
HS Senior	5, 2, 3, 6, 10, 14, 12, 15, 13, 11, 15, 20, 27, 22, 16, 28, 24, 29	recall 5, inference 6, analysis 4, synthesis 3
AP	5, 30, 2, 15, 12, 15, 14, 17, 22, 20, 16, 19, 23, 24, 21, 26, 18, 29	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Freshman	1, 2, 30, 13, 15, 12, 14, 19, 20, 27, 16, 22, 17, 25, 26, 24, 21, 18	recall 3, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 5
College Sophomore	30, 5, 11, 13, 15, 15, 17, 23, 22, 27, 19, 16, 29, 21, 24, 26, 18, 28	recall 2, inference 4, analysis 6, synthesis 6
College Junior	2, 4, 11, 13, 15, 27, 17, 22, 19, 20, 23, 25, 18, 21, 24, 28, 29, 26	recall 2, inference 3, analysis 6, synthesis 7
College Senior	10, 5, 15, 14, 20, 22, 19, 17, 23, 27, 16, 24, 21, 25, 18, 29, 28, 26	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 7, synthesis 7
Graduate / PhD	6, 30, 14, 15, 16, 27, 20, 22, 23, 17, 19, 25, 26, 24, 28, 18, 29, 21	recall 2, inference 2, analysis 7, synthesis 7

Final paper

The Cop and the Anthem: final paper (formal literary analysis). Choose one prompt.

1. Analyze how O. Henry develops homelessness and society across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three moments (beginning, middle and end) and argue what the ending finally suggests.
2. Choose one recurring symbol, image or motif in The Cop and the Anthem and argue how its meaning changes over the story and why that change matters to fate and irony.
3. Analyze a central character's choices in The Cop and the Anthem. Argue whether the story judges that character, and how its structure or point of view shapes your answer.
4. Two readers disagree about whether The Cop and the Anthem finally endorses or criticizes its society's view of redemption. Weigh both readings and argue for one, answering the strongest objection.

Length: Scaffolded support 500-700 words; HS Freshman 700-900 words; HS Sophomore 900-1,100 words; HS Junior 1,000-1,300 words; HS Senior 1,200-1,500 words; AP 1,300-1,600 words; College Freshman 1,500-2,000 words; College Sophomore 2,000-2,500 words; College Junior 2,500-3,000 words; College Senior 3,000-4,000 words; Graduate / PhD 4,000-6,000 words

Evidence requirement: at least 4 quotations from at least two parts of the story. Quote the reading text exactly and cite the paragraph (MLA style). HS Senior and above: one scholarly or historical source; College Sophomore and above: two, cited in MLA.

Criterion	Points	Descriptor	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Thesis	20	A specific, arguable claim that answers the prompt and organizes the paper.	Specific, arguable and precise; it organizes every section.	Clear and arguable, but broad in places.	States a topic or a summary more than an argument.	Missing, or restates the prompt.
Evidence	25	Well-chosen, accurately quoted and cited passages from across the work, meeting the evidence requirement.	Accurate, well-chosen quotations from across the work, all cited; meets the requirement.	Accurate and cited, but clustered in one part of the work.	Too few quotations, or some inaccurate or uncited.	Little or no quoted evidence.
Analysis	30	Explains how language, structure and literary elements create meaning; goes beyond summary.	Explains how specific words, structure and devices create meaning; weighs a competing reading.	Explains the evidence, with some close reading.	Mostly summary; the link to the claim is asserted, not shown.	Summary only.
Organization	15					

		Logical progression, clear topic sentences and transitions; introduction and conclusion frame the argument.	Each paragraph advances the argument; transitions show logic.	Logical order with minor jumps.	Order is loose; paragraphs repeat or drift.	No discernible structure.
Style and conventions	10	Formal academic voice, present tense for literature, correct grammar and MLA format.	Formal, precise, present tense; MLA format; virtually error-free.	Formal with a few errors that do not obscure meaning.	Informal or error-prone in ways that distract.	Errors obscure meaning.

Exemplar paragraph: O. Henry uses irony to show that society punishes the poor regardless of what they choose. The text makes this visible when it says “Three months on the Island was what his soul craved” (The Cop and the Anthem, paragraph 4). Soapy's soul "craved" "Three months on the Island," and he fails to get it by crime, but once he resolves to reform, "the Magistrate" gives him exactly that. A full paper would carry this reading through the beginning, middle and end, and answer the strongest competing reading.

Essay assignments

Essay: Homelessness and society

Scaffolded support (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Cop and the Anthem teaches about homelessness and society. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how O. Henry develops homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how O. Henry develops homelessness and society across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of homelessness and society. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how O. Henry's choices in The Cop and the Anthem (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of homelessness and society, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Cop and the Anthem's treatment of homelessness and society in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on homelessness and society in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Fate and irony

Scaffolded support (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Cop and the Anthem teaches about fate and irony. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how O. Henry develops fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how O. Henry develops fate and irony across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of fate and irony. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how O. Henry's choices in The Cop and the Anthem (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of fate and irony, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Cop and the Anthem's treatment of fate and irony in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on fate and irony in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

Essay: Redemption

Scaffolded support (600 words; AP: see unit standards): Supported track: write a five-paragraph essay explaining what The Cop and the Anthem teaches about redemption. Use at least three quotations from passages your teacher selects from different parts of the book.

HS Freshman (800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a multi-paragraph essay explaining how O. Henry develops redemption in The Cop and the Anthem. Use evidence from the beginning, middle and end of the book.

HS Sophomore (1000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an argumentative essay analyzing how O. Henry develops redemption across The Cop and the Anthem. Trace the idea through at least three parts of the story and address a counterclaim.

HS Junior (1100 words; AP: see unit standards): Write an analytical essay on how the structure of The Cop and the Anthem (its order, turns and ending) shapes the meaning of redemption. Discuss at least one place where the book leaves the question open.

HS Senior (1200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a sustained argument comparing two interpretations of redemption in The Cop and the Anthem. Weigh the evidence for each and defend the stronger reading in a mature, well-organized essay.

AP (1300 words; AP: AP-LIT.LAN): Write a literary argument: develop a defensible thesis about how O. Henry's choices in The Cop and the Anthem (a recurring element, structure and narration) shape a complex understanding of redemption, weigh at least one competing reading, and sustain commentary on well-chosen evidence. Do not merely summarize.

College Freshman (1600 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a researched essay (4–6 pages) that places The Cop and the Anthem's treatment of redemption in its historical context, using at least two scholarly sources.

College Sophomore (2200 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a contextual essay (6–8 pages) on redemption in The Cop and the Anthem that reads the story against its genre and period and engages two published critics. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Junior (2800 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a theoretically informed essay (8–10 pages) on redemption in The Cop and the Anthem. Name your critical method, apply it closely, and acknowledge its limits. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

College Senior (4000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a research paper (12–15 pages) with an original argument about redemption in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging at least four scholarly sources in Chicago style. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Graduate / PhD (6000 words; AP: see unit standards): Write a seminar paper (15–20 pages) that intervenes in the critical conversation on redemption in The Cop and the Anthem, engaging the relevant scholarship and textual history. At this level students write ONE of the unit's essays (choose one theme), not all five.

Rubric: Claim · Evidence · Analysis · Organization · Conventions

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